

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Topic VII — Extremism, Terrorism, Sectarianism and Jihad

The Question Answers · Every past-paper question of Topic 7, 2015–2026,
answered as a model

Eight model answers — Jihad and Fasad, the principles of Jihad, 'Is extremism a challenge to Islam?', the reasons and motives of extremism and terrorism in Pakistan in three different shapes, eliminating religious and political extremism through the Prophet's teachings, and sectarianism and polarisation. Each begins with an answer map that states exactly what the question asks.

Contents

HOW TO BUILD THE CONTENTS

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How to Use These Answers

What is in this document

#	Paper	Question (short)	Answer
1	2015 Q3	Jihad and Fasad; Jihad in today's international scenario	Answer 1
2	2020 Q5	Principles and conditions of Jihad in the Quran and Sunnah	Answer 2
3	2019 Q7	Is extremism a challenge to Islam? — the Ummah's context	Answer 3
4	2017 Q7	Reasons of extremism in Pakistan; solutions in the light of Islam	Answer 4
5	2018 Q4	Motives of terrorism in Pakistan; how society can get rid of it	Answer 5
6	2023 Q7	Motives of extremism; how society can get rid of it by following Islam	Answer 6
7	2024 Q7	Eliminating religious and political extremism through the Prophet's ﷺ teachings	Answer 7
8	2026 Q7	Causes of sectarianism and polarisation in the Muslim world; solutions	Answer 8

The three Pakistan-extremism questions (2017, 2018, 2023) are answered in **three different shapes**: reasons by category (2017), terrorism's phases and motives (2018), and society's institutions (2023).

How every answer is built

1. **The question**, exactly as set.
2. **The answer map** — the centre states **exactly what the question asks**; every box is a heading, and every point is a complete idea.
3. **Decoding the question**.
4. **The model answer** — headings from the question's words; evidence **Quran → Hadith → Companions and jurists → data and law**; figures; Pakistan; a conclusion with a verse or hadith.
5. **Why this answer scores**.

TRAP · NO SECT, NO NAMES

Condemn **acts and ideas** — takfir, suicide attacks, rebellion, hate speech — never a school of thought.
Quote Paigham-e-Pakistan as the common Pakistani position.

Answer 1 · Jihad and Fasad; Jihad in Today's International Scenario (CSS 2015)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q3 · 16 marks

What is the difference between Jihad and Fasaad (Hostility)? Discuss the possibilities of practical application of Quranic concept of Jihad in current international scenario.

Define both → compare in a table → forms of Jihad that can be applied today → what is not Jihad.

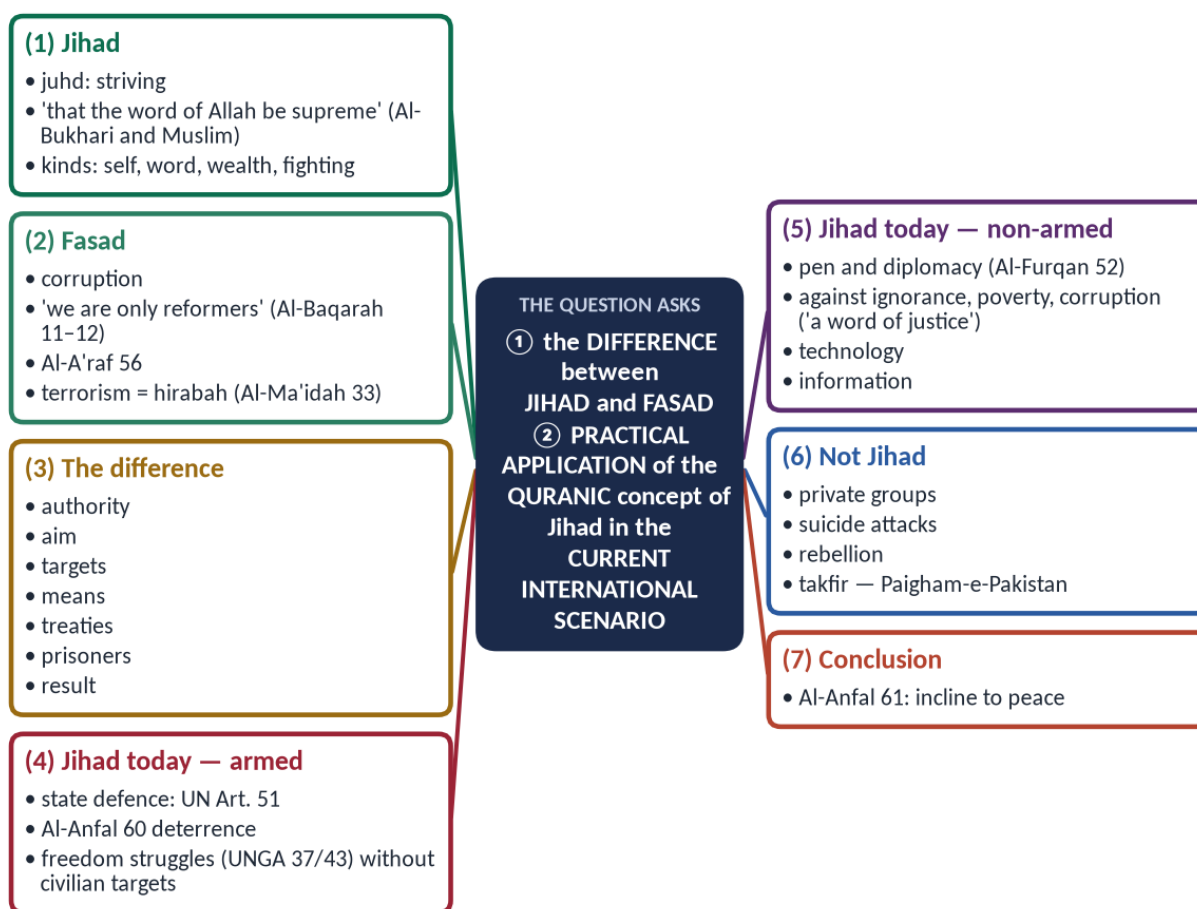


Figure 1 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **Limb 1** — define **Jihad** and **Fasad** and show the **difference** point by point.
- **Limb 2** — 'possibilities of practical application ... in current international scenario' — how the Quranic Jihad can be practised **today**, within international law, and what is excluded.
- **16 marks** — keep it tight.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Few Islamic words are as misunderstood as **Jihad** (جِهَاد). Terrorists misuse it for murder; critics equate it with holy war. The Quran uses it for **striving** in Allah's way in every field, and it clearly separates it from **Fasad** (فَسَاد) — corruption and mischief on earth.

(2) The meaning of Jihad

From **juhd** — effort — Jihad is striving to make the word of Allah supreme and to establish justice: against the self, with knowledge and word, with wealth, and — under the state and its conditions — with arms.

♦ HADITH

مَنْ قَاتَلَ لِتَكُونَ كَلِمَةُ اللَّهِ هِيَ الْعُلْيَا فَهُوَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ

“Whoever fights so that the word of Allah is supreme is in the way of Allah.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

♦ QURAN

﴿فَلَا تُطِعِ الْكَافِرِينَ وَجَاهِدْهُمْ بِهِ ۖ جِهَادًا كَبِيرًا﴾

“So do not obey the disbelievers, and strive against them with the Qur'an a great striving.” (Al-Furqan, Quran)

→ ‘Strive against them with it (the Quran) a great striving’ — a Makkan command, before any fighting was allowed.

♦ QURAN

﴿وَجَاهِدُوا فِي اللَّهِ حَقَّ جِهَادِهِ...﴾

“And strive for Allah with the striving due to Him.” (Al-Hajj, Quran)

→ Jihad is first a **striving**, in every field.

The levels of Jihad (Ibn al-Qayyim, *Zad al-Ma'ad*): against the **self**, against **Shaytan**, against **disbelievers and hypocrites** (by argument, wealth and — under the state — arms), and against **oppression and wrongdoing**. Armed struggle is only one level, and the last.

(3) The meaning of Fasad

Fasad is spoiling what Allah made sound — life, property, peace and society.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِذَا قِيلَ لَهُمْ لَا تُفْسِدُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ قَالُوا إِنَّمَا نَحْنُ مُصْلِحُونَ ۖ أَلَا إِنَّهُمْ هُمُ الْمُفْسِدُونَ وَلَكِنْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ﴾

"And when it is said to them, "Do not cause corruption on the earth," they say, "We are but reformers. Unquestionably, it is they who are the corrupters, but they perceive [it] not." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ When told 'do not spread corruption', they say 'we are only reformers'. **Indeed, it is they who are the corrupters.**

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَا تُفْسِدُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ بَعْدَ إِصْلَاحِهَا وَادْعُوهُ خَوْفًا وَطَمَعًا إِنَّ رَحْمَتَ اللَّهِ قَرِيبٌ مِّنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ﴾

"And cause not corruption upon the earth after its reformation. And invoke Him in fear and aspiration. Indeed, the mercy of Allah is near to the doers of good." (Al-A'raf, Quran)

→ 'Do not cause corruption in the land after it has been set right.'

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّمَا جَزَاءُ الَّذِينَ يُحَارِبُونَ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ وَيَسْعَوْنَ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَسَادًا ...﴾

"The recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and strive to spread corruption (fasad) in the land ..." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ The recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and spread fasad in the land ...

✦ QURAN

﴿ظَهَرَ الْفَسَادُ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ بِمَا كَسَبَتْ أَيْدِي النَّاسِ لِيُذِيقَهُمْ بَعْضَ الَّذِي عَمِلُوا لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْجِعُونَ﴾

"Corruption has appeared throughout the land and sea by [reason of] what the hands of people have earned so He may let them taste part of [the consequence of] what they have done that perhaps they will return [to righteousness]." (Ar-Rum, Quran)

→ 'Corruption has appeared on land and sea because of what the hands of people have earned.'

Fasad in today's world: terrorism and suicide bombing; sectarian killing; corruption and theft of public wealth; drug and arms trafficking; hoarding and adulteration; environmental destruction.

(4) The difference between Jihad and Fasad

	JIHAD	FASAD / TERRORISM
Authority	declared by the state	private groups, self-appointed
Aim	defence; end oppression; peace	fear, chaos, power
Targets	combatants only	civilians, mosques, schools
Means	lawful, proportionate	suicide bombs, beheading
Treaties	honoured (Al-Anfal 58, 72)	broken, ignored
Prisoners	fed; freed or ransomed	killed, tortured
Result	security and justice	destruction — hirabah (Al-Ma'idah 33)

Figure 2 · Jihad and Fasad compared.

Point	Jihad	Fasad
Authority	The state	Self-appointed groups
Aim	Defence, justice, peace	Fear, chaos, power
Targets	Combatants only	Civilians, mosques, schools
Means	Lawful, proportionate	Suicide bombs, beheading
Treaties	Honoured (Al-Anfal 58)	Broken
Prisoners	Fed; freed or ransomed (Muhammad 4)	Killed
Result	Security and justice	Destruction

(5) The practical application of Jihad in the current international scenario

(i) Defensive Jihad by the state

★ QURAN

﴿وَأَعِدُّوا لَهُمْ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ مِنْ قُوَّةٍ وَمِنْ رِبَاطِ الْخَيْلِ تُرْهِبُونَ بِهِ عَدُوَّ اللَّهِ وَعَدُوَّكُمْ...﴾

“Prepare against them whatever you are able of power and of steeds of war, by which you may deter the enemy of Allah and your enemy.” (Al-Anfal, Quran)

→ Prepare whatever strength you can **to deter** the enemy.

Every state's right of self-defence is recognised by **Article 51 of the UN Charter**; Pakistan's armed forces and its deterrence are Jihad in this lawful sense.

(ii) Struggles against occupation

International law recognises the right of peoples under foreign occupation to self-determination (UNGA Resolution 37/43, 1982) — as in Kashmir and Palestine — but **civilians may never be targeted**.

(iii) Jihad of the pen, diplomacy and law

Advocacy at the UN, the ICJ and human-rights forums; scholarship and media that answer Islamophobia.

(iv) Jihad against ignorance, poverty and disease

Education, science, Zakat and health — the Ummah's greatest battles today.

(v) Jihad against corruption and tyranny

✦ HADITH

أَفْضَلُ الْجِهَادِ كَلِمَةُ عَدْلٍ عِنْدَ سُلْطَانٍ جَائِرٍ

"The best jihad is a word of justice before a tyrant ruler." (Abu Dawud and Al-Tirmidhi)

(vi) Jihad against the self

✦ HADITH

الْمُجَاهِدُ مَنْ جَاهَدَ نَفْسَهُ

"The true mujahid is the one who strives against his own self." (Al-Tirmidhi)

(viii) Jihad through service

A man asked the Prophet ﷺ for permission to join a campaign; he asked, 'Are your parents alive?' — 'Yes.' — 'Then strive in serving them' (Al-Bukhari and Muslim): **فَقِيْمَا جَاهِدَ**. Service to parents, the poor and the sick is Jihad too.

(vii) Technological and economic Jihad

Self-reliance in defence, energy and technology — strength that makes war less likely.

(6) What is not Jihad

Attacks by **private groups**, **suicide bombings**, **rebellion** against Muslim states, and **takfir** to justify killing — all are **fasad**. **Paigham-e-Pakistan (2018)**, signed by over 1,800 scholars of all schools, declared that **only the state may declare jihad**.

Pakistan's law agrees: Article 256 of the Constitution forbids private military organisations, and the **Anti-Terrorism Act (1997)** punishes violence meant to spread fear. The Islamic and the constitutional positions are the same — Jihad belongs to the state, within law.

(7) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِنْ جَنَحُوا لِلسَّلَامِ فَاجْنَحْ لَهَا وَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ﴾

"And if they incline to peace, then incline to it [also] and rely upon Allah. Indeed, it is He who is the Hearing, the Knowing." (Al-Anfal, Quran)

→ 'If they incline to peace, incline to it and rely upon Allah.'

Jihad is lawful striving for justice and peace, bound by the state and by rules; Fasad is lawless destruction. In today's world, the Quranic Jihad is practised by lawful defence, by the pen and diplomacy, and above all by the struggle against ignorance, poverty and corruption.

Why this answer scores

- **Both concepts defined** with Quran and Hadith; the difference shown in a **table**.
- **Seven practical forms** of Jihad today, tied to **international law** (Art. 51; UNGA 37/43).
- A clear line on **what is not Jihad**, with Paigham-e-Pakistan.

Answer 2 · The Principles and Conditions of Jihad (CSS 2020)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2020 · Q5 · 20 marks

Discuss in detail the principles and terms & conditions for "Jihad" in the light of Quran and Sunnah.

Meaning and kinds briefly; then the principles and conditions of armed Jihad, each with a verse or hadith.

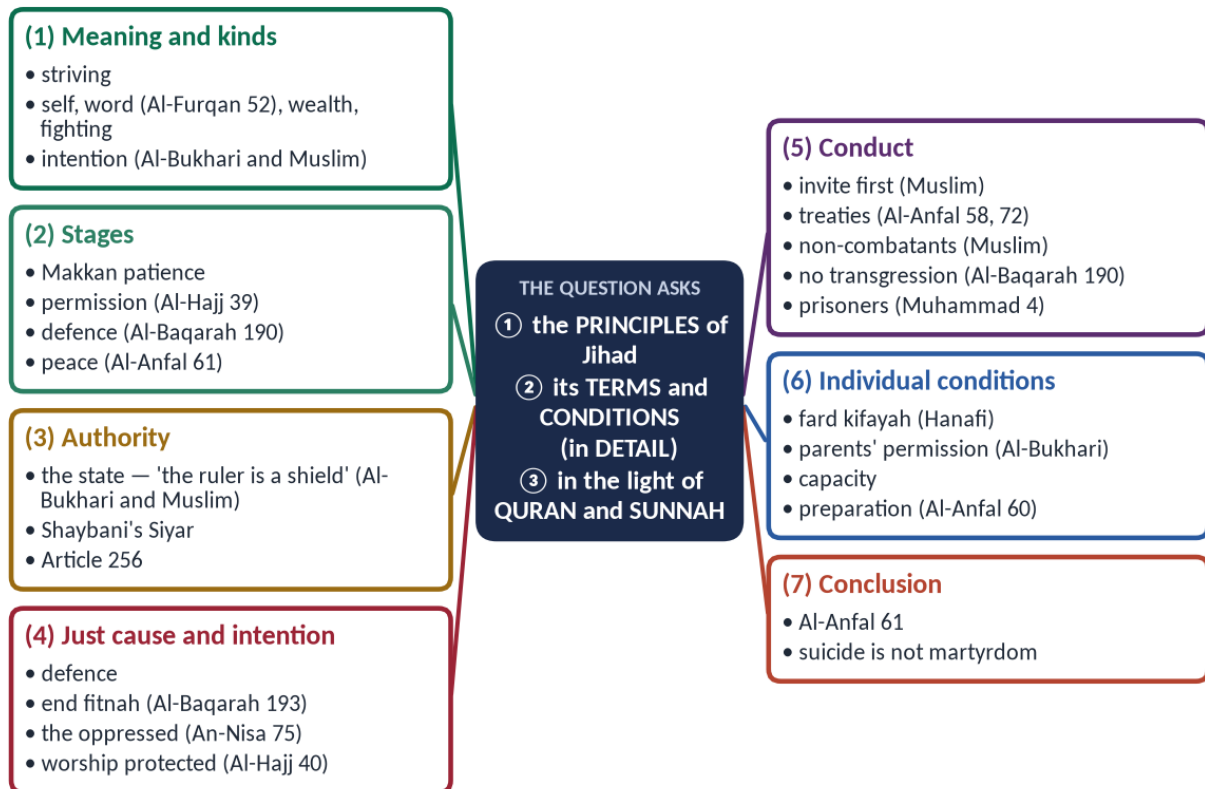


Figure 3 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- 'Principles' — the fundamental rules that govern Jihad.
- 'Terms and conditions' — when it becomes lawful, who may declare it, how it must be fought, and who must take part.
- 'In detail' and 'in the light of Quran and Sunnah' — each condition with evidence.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Jihad (جهاد), from **juhd** (effort), is striving in the way of Allah. Armed struggle (**qital**) is one form of it, surrounded by strict principles that make it a **just, limited and lawful** act — the opposite of terrorism.

(2) The kinds of Jihad

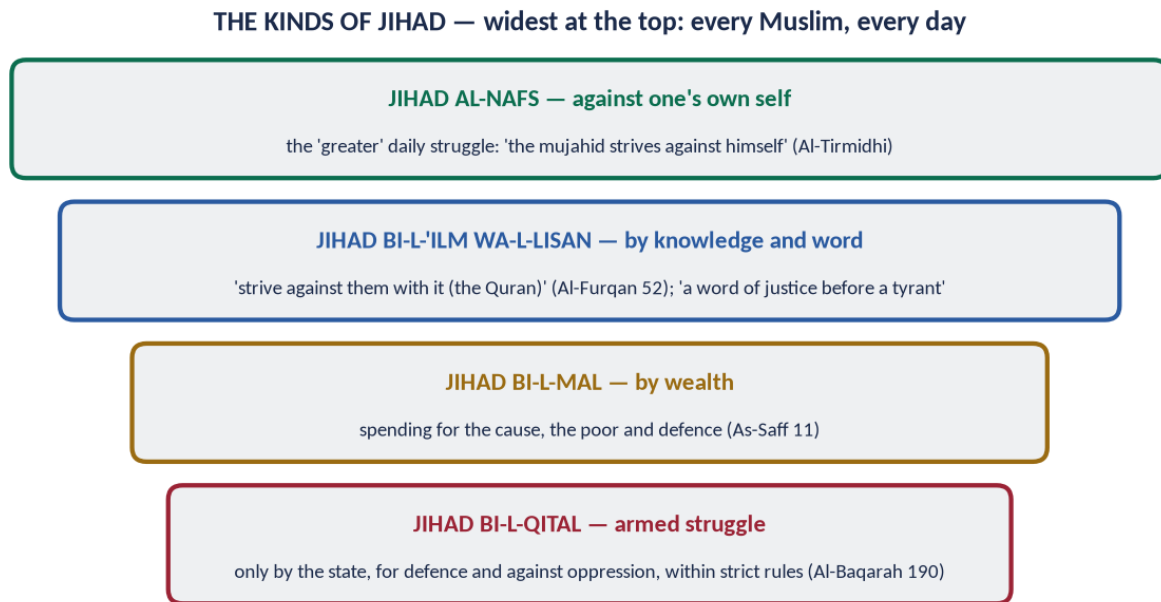


Figure 4 · The kinds of Jihad.

- Against the **self** — 'the true mujahid strives against his own self' (Al-Tirmidhi).
- By **knowledge and word** — 'strive against them with it (the Quran)' (Al-Furqan 52).
- By **wealth** — As-Saff 11.
- By **fighting** — under the conditions below.

(3) The stages of the command



Fighting came late, as a last resort, under a state, with limits — and always gave way to peace.

Figure 5 · Patience, permission, defence, treaties.

Thirteen Makkan years of patience; permission after persecution (Al-Hajj 39); defence without transgression (Al-Baqarah 190); peace whenever offered (Al-Anfal 61).

✦ QURAN

﴿كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْقِتَالُ وَهُوَ كُرْهٌ لَّكُمْ...﴾

“Fighting has been prescribed for you, though it is hateful to you.” (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ 'Fighting has been prescribed for you, though it is hateful to you' — never loved for itself.

(4) The principles and conditions of armed Jihad

(i) Authority — only the state

✦ HADITH

إِنَّمَا الْإِمَامُ جُنَّةٌ يُقَاتَلُ مِنْ وَرَائِهِ وَيَتَّقَى بِهِ

“The ruler is a shield: one fights behind him and is protected by him.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

The Hanafi jurist **Imam Muhammad al-Shaybani** (d. 805), in *Kitab al-Siyar al-Kabir*, placed the declaration and conduct of war with the ruler. Pakistan's **Article 256** forbids private military organisations.

(ii) A just cause

✦ QURAN

﴿أُذِنَ لِلَّذِينَ يُقَاتِلُونَ بِأَنَّهُمْ ظَلِمُوا وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَىٰ نَصْرِهِمْ لَقَدِيرٌ﴾

“Permission [to fight] has been given to those who are being fought, because they were wronged. And indeed, Allah is competent to give them victory.” (Al-Hajj, Quran)

→ Permission is given to those who are fought against, **because they have been wronged**.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَقَاتِلُوهُمْ حَتَّىٰ لَا تَكُونَ فِتْنَةٌ وَيَكُونَ الدِّينُ لِلَّهِ فَإِنْ آنَهَوْا فَلَا عُدْوَانَ إِلَّا عَلَى الظَّالِمِينَ﴾

“Fight them until there is no [more] fitnah and [until] worship is [acknowledged to be] for Allah. But if they cease, then there is to be no aggression except against the oppressors.” (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ Fight until there is **no more fitnah (persecution)**.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَمَا لَكُمْ لَا تُقَاتِلُونَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَالْمُسْتَضْعَفِينَ مِنَ الرِّجَالِ وَالنِّسَاءِ وَالْوِلْدَانِ...﴾

“What is wrong with you that you do not fight in the cause of Allah and for the oppressed among men, women and children?” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Fight **for the oppressed men, women and children**.

Not for land, wealth, revenge or forced conversion — 'no compulsion in religion' (Al-Baqarah 256).

(iii) The right intention

'Whoever fights so that **the word of Allah is supreme** is in the way of Allah' (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) — not for booty, fame or pride.

(iv) Invitation and warning first

The Prophet ﷺ instructed his commanders to offer **Islam, a treaty or peace** before fighting (Muslim, the hadith of Buraydah).

(v) Honouring treaties

✦ QURAN

﴿وَأَمَّا تَخَافَنَّ مِنْ قَوْمٍ خِيَانَةً فَانْبِذْ إِلَيْهِمْ عَلَى سَوَاءٍ إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْخَائِنِينَ﴾

"If you [have reason to] fear from a people betrayal, throw [their treaty] back to them, [putting you] on equal terms. Indeed, Allah does not like traitors." (Al-Anfal, Quran)

→ If you fear treachery, **openly declare the treaty ended** — no surprise attack in peace.

✦ QURAN

﴿... وَإِنْ أَسْتَنْصَرُوكُمْ فِي الدِّينِ فَعَلَيْكُمْ النَّصْرُ ...﴾

"And if they seek your help in the matter of religion, then it is your duty to help them." (Al-Anfal, Quran)

→ Help your fellow believers **except against a people with whom you have a treaty**.

(vi) Protection of non-combatants

✦ HADITH

اغْزُوا بِاسْمِ اللَّهِ ... وَلَا تَغْلُوا، وَلَا تَغْدِرُوا، وَلَا تَمْثُلُوا، وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا وَلِيدًا

"Fight in the name of Allah ... do not steal, do not betray, do not mutilate, do not kill a child." (Muslim)

Women, children, the old and monks are protected; fruit trees and towns spared (Abu Bakr's orders, Muwatta).

(vii) Proportionality

✦ QURAN

﴿وَقَاتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ الَّذِينَ يُقْتُلُونَكُم وَلَا تَعْتَدُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُعْتَدِينَ﴾

"Fight in the way of Allah those who fight you but do not transgress. Indeed, Allah does not like transgressors." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ Fight those who fight you, **but do not transgress**; Allah does not love transgressors.

(viii) Humane treatment of prisoners

✦ QURAN

﴿... فَإِمَّا مَنًّا بَعْدُ وَإِمَّا فِدَاءً حَتَّى تَضَعَ الْحَرْبُ أَوْزَارَهَا ...﴾

"... then either free them as a favour or for ransom, until the war lays down its burdens." (Muhammad, Quran)

→ ... **either free them as a favour or for ransom**.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَيُطْعَمُونَ عَلَىٰ حُبِّهِ مِسْكِينًا وَيَتِيمًا وَأَسِيرًا﴾

“And they give food in spite of love for it to the needy, the orphan, and the captive.” (Al-Insan, Quran)

→ They give food ... **to the captive**.

(ix) Peace when offered

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِنْ جَنَحُوا لِلسَّلَامِ فَاجْنَحْ لَهَا وَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ﴾

“And if they incline to peace, then incline to it [also] and rely upon Allah. Indeed, it is He who is the Hearing, the Knowing.” (Al-Anfal, Quran)

→ 'If they incline to peace, incline to it.'

(x) Individual conditions

- **Fard kifayah** normally; **fard 'ayn** only on a general mobilisation by the state (Hanafi).
- **Parents' permission** for voluntary service — 'Then strive in serving them' (Al-Bukhari).
- **Capacity** — adult, sane, able.
- **Preparation** — 'prepare whatever strength you can' (Al-Anfal 60).

Principle	Evidence
State authority	'The ruler is a shield'; Shaybani; Art. 256
Just cause	Al-Hajj 39; Al-Baqarah 193; An-Nisa 75
Intention	'That the word of Allah be supreme'
Invitation first	Hadith of Buraydah
Treaties	Al-Anfal 58, 72
Non-combatants	Muslim; Muwatta
No transgression	Al-Baqarah 190
Prisoners	Muhammad 4; Al-Insan 8
Peace	Al-Anfal 61

(5) Martyrdom and suicide

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَا تَحْسَبَنَّ الَّذِينَ قُتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَاتًا بَلْ أَحْيَاءٌ عِنْدَ رَبِّهِمْ يُرْزَقُونَ﴾

“And never think of those who have been killed in the cause of Allah as dead. Rather, they are alive with their Lord, receiving provision.” (Aal-e-Imran, Quran)

→ Those killed in the way of Allah **are alive with their Lord**.

Martyrdom belongs to one who falls in a lawful struggle, with a pure intention, by the enemy's hand; a **suicide bomber** who kills innocents commits suicide and murder — he is no martyr.

(6) Conclusion

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Paigham-e-Pakistan (2018) · Consensus of 1,800+ scholars

Only the state may declare jihad; suicide attacks are haram; armed rebellion against the state is baghawat.

→ The **Pakistani consensus** on the conditions of Jihad.

Jihad in the Quran and Sunnah is a disciplined institution: declared by the state, for a just cause, with a pure intention, after warning, within treaties, sparing non-combatants and prisoners, and ending in peace. These conditions are exactly what separate it from terrorism.

Why this answer scores

- **Ten principles and conditions**, each with Quran or Hadith — 'in detail'.
- **Hanafi** authority (Shaybani) and **Pakistani law** (Article 256).
- A summary **table** and the martyrdom–suicide distinction.

Answer 3 · Is Extremism a Challenge to Islam? — In the Context of the Ummah's Challenges (CSS 2019)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2019 · Q7 · 20 marks

Is extremism a challenge to Islam? Discuss in the context of contemporary challenges faced by Muslim Ummah.

Define; show Islam's position; prove the thesis; show how extremism multiplies the Ummah's other challenges; solutions.

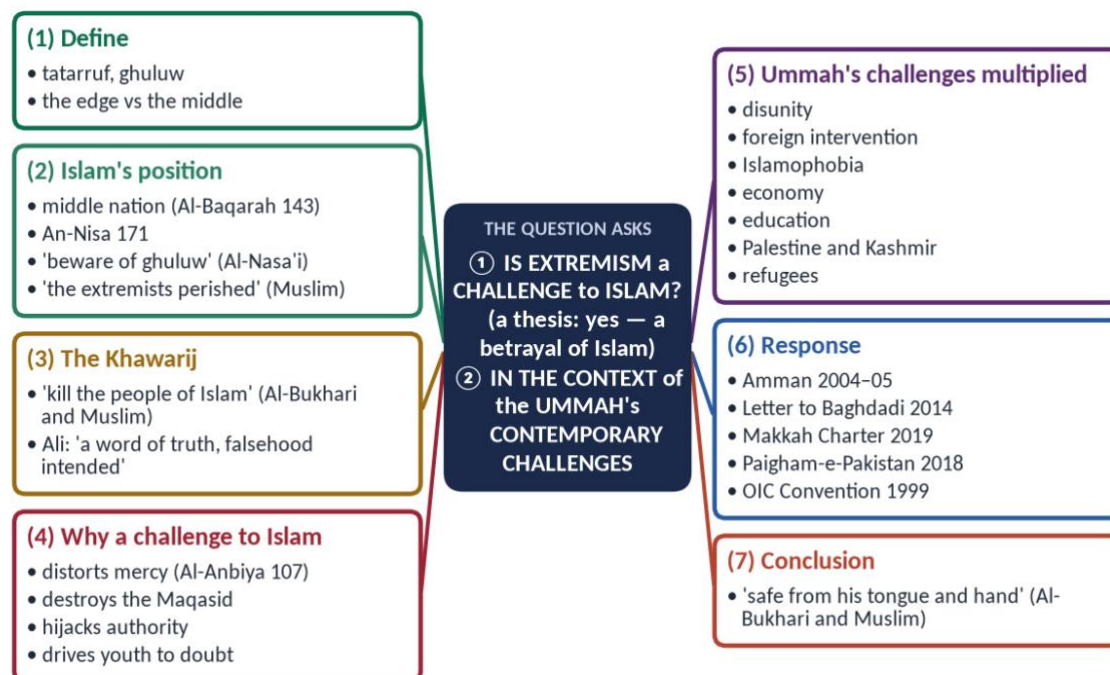


Figure 6 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- 'Is extremism a challenge to Islam?' — a **thesis** question: answer **yes**, and explain that extremism is a **betrayal** of Islam, not an expression of it.
- 'In the context of contemporary challenges faced by the Muslim Ummah' — show how extremism relates to and **worsens** the Ummah's other challenges.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

The Muslim Ummah faces disunity, poverty, occupation, Islamophobia and cultural pressure. Among these, **extremism** is unique: it wears the dress of Islam while attacking Islam's own teachings. It is therefore a challenge **to Islam itself** — to its message, its image and its people.

(2) What extremism is

Tatarruf (تَطَرُّفٌ) — standing at the edge; **ghuluw** (غُلُوٌّ) — exceeding the limits. Extremism is going beyond the limits Allah set, in belief, word and action — making religion harsh, declaring others disbelievers, and using violence.

'Beware of extremism in religion, for it destroyed those before you' (Al-Nasa'i)

'The religion is easy; no one makes it hard except that it overcomes him' (Al-Bukhari)

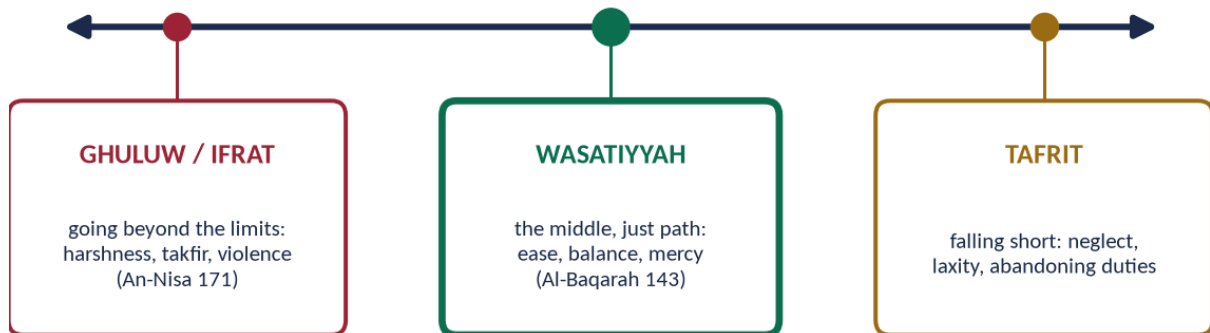


Figure 7 · Ghuluw, wasatiyyah and tafrit.

Firmness is not extremism. A Muslim who prays, fasts and keeps a beard or hijab is practising, not extreme. Extremism begins when one **imposes** one's view by force, **excludes** others from Islam, and **permits violence**. It appears at four levels:

- **In belief** — takfir of Muslims and rulers.
- **In worship** — burdens Allah did not impose; the Prophet ﷺ corrected the three men who vowed never to sleep, never to break fast and never to marry: 'Whoever turns away from my Sunnah is not of me' (Al-Bukhari).
- **In conduct** — harshness, contempt and hate speech.
- **In politics** — rebellion and terrorism in the name of religion.

(3) Islam's position — the middle path

✦ QURAN

﴿وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ عَلَيْكُمْ شَهِيدًا...﴾

"And thus We have made you a middle (just) nation, that you may be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger a witness over you." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ 'We have made you a middle nation.'

✦ QURAN

﴿... لَا تَغْلُوا فِي دِينِكُمْ وَلَا تَقُولُوا عَلَى اللَّهِ إِلَّا الْحَقَّ...﴾

"O People of the Scripture, do not go to extremes in your religion, and do not say about Allah except the truth." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ 'Do not go to extremes in your religion.'

✦ HADITH

إِيَّاكُمْ وَالْغُلُوَّ فِي الدِّينِ، فَإِنَّمَا أَهْلَكَ مَنْ كَانَ قَبْلَكُمْ الْغُلُوَّ فِي الدِّينِ

"Beware of extremism in religion, for those before you were destroyed only by extremism in religion." (Al-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah)

✦ HADITH

هَلَكَ الْمُتَنَطِعُونَ

"The extremists perished." (Muslim)

→ Said three times.

(4) The first extremists — the Khawarij

✦ HADITH

يَقْتُلُونَ أَهْلَ الْإِسْلَامِ وَيَدْعُونَ أَهْلَ الْأَوْثَانِ

"They will kill the people of Islam and leave the idol-worshippers alone." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

They emerged after Siffin (657) with the slogan 'judgement is only for Allah'; **Ali (RA)** called it 'a word of truth by which falsehood is intended' (Muslim), sent **Ibn Abbas** to reason with them, and fought them only when they killed Muslims (Nahrawan, 658). Modern extremist groups repeat their features: takfir, literalism and violence against Muslims.

✦ HADITH

يَقْرَأُونَ الْقُرْآنَ لَا يُجَاوِزُ حَنَاجِرَهُمْ

"They recite the Quran, but it does not go beyond their throats." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ Much outward piety, no understanding — the mark of every extremist movement since.

(5) Why extremism is a challenge to Islam

- **(a) It distorts the message** — 'a mercy to all the worlds' (Al-Anbiya 107) becomes, in the world's eyes, a religion of terror.
- **(b) It destroys the Maqasid** — life, faith, intellect, lineage and property — the very aims of the Shari'ah.
- **(c) It hijacks religious authority** — unqualified men issue fatwas of death.
- **(d) It drives young Muslims away** — disgust at violence in God's name breeds doubt.
- **(e) It kills Muslims most** — the majority of terrorism's victims worldwide are Muslims.

✦ QURAN

﴿... مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا وَمَنْ أَحْيَاهَا فَكَأَنَّمَا أَحْيَا النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا...﴾

"Whoever kills a soul — unless for a soul or for corruption in the land — it is as if he had slain mankind entirely; and whoever saves one, it is as if he had saved mankind entirely." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Killing one innocent soul is like killing all mankind.

Recent examples: ISIS (2014–2019) declared a 'caliphate' in Iraq and Syria, killed mostly Muslims, destroyed mosques and shrines and drove millions from their homes; in Pakistan, the TTP attacked schools, mosques and markets. Both claimed Islam; both were rejected by the scholars of the Ummah.

(6) How extremism multiplies the Ummah's other challenges

Challenge	How extremism worsens it
Disunity	Takfir and sectarian war split the Ummah
Foreign intervention	Terror gives a pretext (Afghanistan 2001, Iraq 2003)
Islamophobia	Each attack feeds anti-Muslim hate
Economic backwardness	Investment and tourism flee; budgets go to security
Education	Schools destroyed; girls kept out (Swat 2008–09)
Palestine and Kashmir	Terror weakens the moral case of just causes
Refugees	Wars fuelled by extremists displaced millions (Syria, Iraq)

Pakistan's own experience: over 80,000 killed and over **126 billion dollars** lost (2001–2018); no international cricket for a decade after the attack on the Sri Lankan team (Lahore, 2009).

(7) The Ummah's response

- **Scholarly consensus:** the **Amman Message** (2004–05); the **Letter to Baghdadi** (2014); the **Charter of Makkah** (2019, 1,200+ scholars); **Paigham-e-Pakistan** (2018).
- **Institutions:** the **OIC Convention on Combating International Terrorism** (1999); the **IMCTC** (2015).
- **Still needed:** an end to proxy wars; justice for Palestine and Kashmir through law; education and jobs for youth.

What the Ummah must still do:

- **Education** — teaching the Quran with context and the jurists' principles, so that half-knowledge cannot be exploited.
- **Justice and good governance** — removing the grievances extremists exploit.
- **Dialogue** — engaging the young, as Ibn Abbas engaged the Khawarij.
- **Freedom of belief** — 'There is no compulsion in religion' (Al-Baqarah 256) forbids forcing faith on anyone.

Pakistan's contribution — the sacrifices of its soldiers, police and citizens; the **National Action Plan** (2014); and **Paigham-e-Pakistan**, which other Muslim countries have studied as a model.

Is extremism a challenge to Islam? — the names only			
Islam's position	Khawarij	Challenge to Islam	Ummah's challenges
middle nation An-Nisa 171 'beware of ghuluw' 'the extremists perished'	'kill the people of Islam' 'a word of truth...' Ibn Abbas Nahrawan	distorts mercy destroys Maqasid hijacks authority drives youth away kills Muslims	disunity intervention Islamophobia economy education causes weakened refugees — Amman, Makkah Charter, Paigham-e-Pakistan

Figure 8 · At a glance — is extremism a challenge to Islam? — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(8) Conclusion

✦ HADITH

الْمُسْلِمُ مَنْ سَلِمَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ مِنْ لِسَانِهِ وَيَدِهِ

"The Muslim is the one from whose tongue and hand the Muslims are safe." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Extremism is indeed a challenge to Islam — the gravest from within. It betrays the middle path, destroys the aims of the Shari'ah, and multiplies every other challenge the Ummah faces. The answer is the Islam of the Quran and Sunnah itself: moderation, knowledge, justice and unity.

Why this answer scores

- A clear **thesis** (yes — a betrayal) proved from Quran, Sunnah and history.
- The **Ummah context** is shown in a table — extremism as a multiplier of other challenges.
- The response includes **scholarly and institutional** evidence.

Answer 4 · Reasons of Extremism in Pakistan and Solutions in the Light of Islam (CSS 2017)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2017 · Q7 · 20 marks

Enumerate the reasons of extremism in Pakistan and suggest solutions to eradicate it in the light of Islamic teachings.

Reasons by category (religious, political, socio-economic, external, psychological, legal); each matched with an Islamic solution.

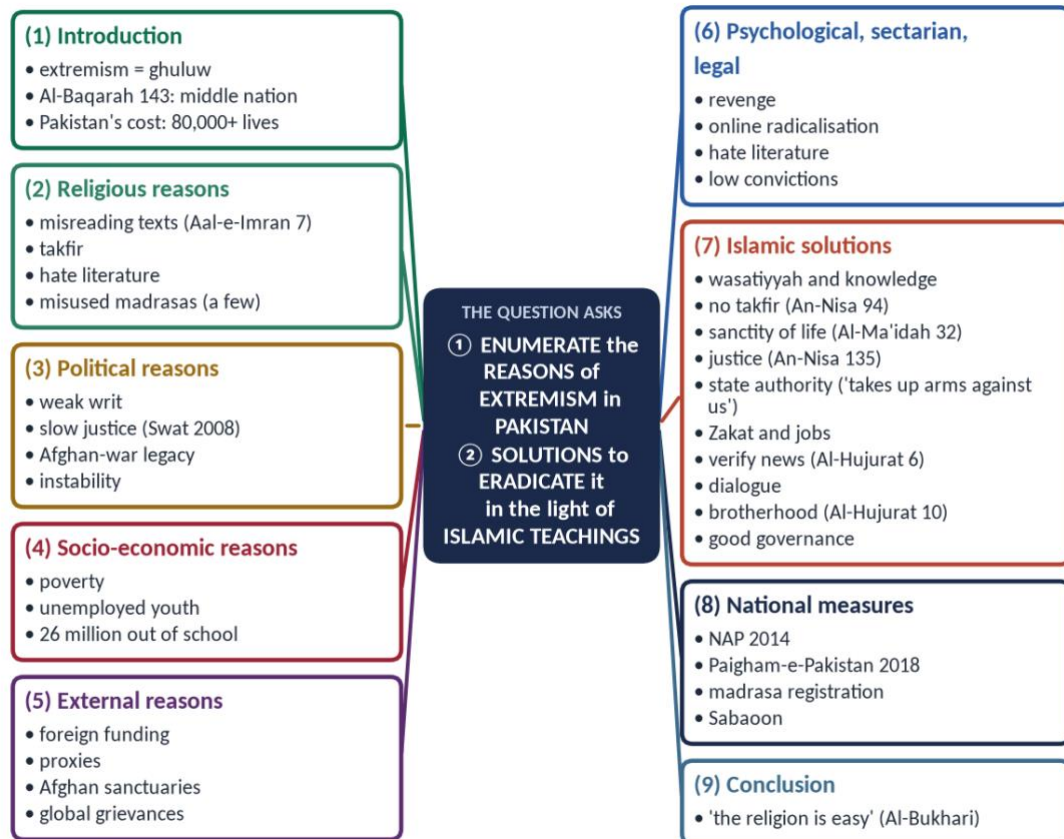


Figure 9 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- 'Enumerate the reasons' — a list, grouped and explained, specific to **Pakistan**.
- 'Solutions ... in the light of Islamic teachings' — each solution with a verse or hadith, plus practical steps.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Extremism — ghuluw (غلو), going beyond Allah's limits — has cost Pakistan over **80,000 lives** and over **126 billion dollars** (2001–2018). It is contrary to the Quran's middle path:

✦ QURAN

﴿وَكَذَلِكَ جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ وَيَكُونَ الرَّسُولُ عَلَيْكُمْ شَهِيدًا...﴾

“And thus We have made you a middle (just) nation, that you may be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger a witness over you.” (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ 'We have made you a middle nation.'

(2) The reasons of extremism in Pakistan

THE ROOTS OF EXTREMISM — cut every root, not only the branches

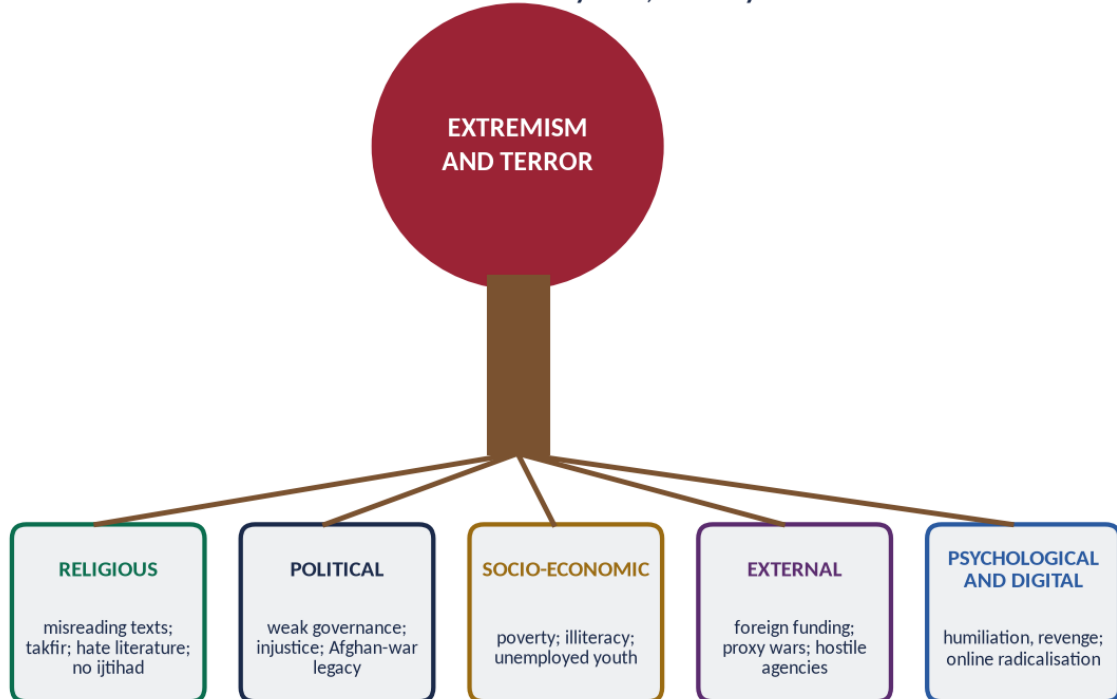


Figure 10 · The roots of extremism.

(i) Religious and ideological

- **Misinterpretation** of verses of war out of context; ignorance of the jurists' conditions.

✦ QURAN

﴿... فَأَمَّا الَّذِينَ فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ زَيْغٌ فَيَتَّبِعُونَ مَا تَشَبَّهَ مِنْهُ ابْتِغَاءَ الْفِتْنَةِ وَابْتِغَاءَ تَأْوِيلِهِ...﴾

“As for those in whose hearts is deviation, they follow what is ambiguous in it, seeking discord and seeking an interpretation of it.” (Aal-e-Imran, Quran)

→ Those in whose hearts is deviation **follow what is ambiguous, seeking fitnah.**

- **Takfir** of the state, the army and other Muslims.
- **Hate literature and sermons**; misuse of loudspeakers.
- **Misuse of a small number of madrasas** by militant groups.

(ii) Political

- The **legacy of the Afghan war** (1979–89): weapons, refugees, armed groups.
- **Weak writ of the state** in former FATA and parts of Balochistan.
- **Slow and costly justice** — in **Swat (2008)** militants won support by promising 'quick justice'.

- **Political instability** and polarisation.

(iii) Socio-economic

- **Poverty** and **unemployment** among a young population.
- **Illiteracy** — about 26 million children out of school.
- **Social injustice** — the powerful above the law.

(iv) External

- **Foreign funding** of sectarian and militant groups; **proxy conflicts**; **sanctuaries** across the Afghan border.
- **Global grievances** — Palestine, Kashmir, drone strikes — exploited in propaganda.

(v) Psychological and digital

- **Revenge** for relatives killed; **humiliation** and identity crisis.
- **Online radicalisation** — videos, encrypted chats.

(vi) Sectarian

Hate literature and target killings between schools, often funded from outside; weak action against hate speech.

(vii) Legal and administrative

Low conviction rates, weak witness protection, terror financing (FATF grey list, 2018–2022).

(3) The solutions in the light of Islamic teachings

(i) Wasatiyyah through true knowledge

✦ HADITH

إِنَّ الدِّينَ يَسْرٌ، وَلَنْ يُشَادَّ الدِّينَ أَحَدٌ إِلَّا غَلَبَهُ

"The religion is easy; no one makes it hard except that it overcomes him." (Al-Bukhari)

Teach the Quran with its context and the jurists' principles; the Seerah of mercy in every school and madrasa.

(ii) No takfir

✦ QURAN

﴿... إِذَا ضَرَبْتُمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَتَبَيَّنُوا وَلَا تَقُولُوا لِمَنْ أَلْفَقَ إِلَيْكُمْ أَلَسْتُمْ مُؤْمِنًا...﴾

"O you who believe, when you go forth in the cause of Allah, verify, and do not say to one who offers you peace, 'You are not a believer.'" (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Do not say to one who offers you peace, **'You are not a believer.'**

✦ HADITH

إِذَا قَالَ الرَّجُلُ لِأَخِيهِ يَا كَافِرُ، فَقَدْ بَاءَ بِهِ أَحَدُهُمَا

"If a man calls his brother 'disbeliever', it returns to one of them." (Al-Bukhari)

(iii) The sanctity of life — no suicide attacks

✦ QURAN

﴿... مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا وَمَنْ أَحْيَاهَا فَكَأَنَّمَا أَحْيَا النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا...﴾

"Whoever kills a soul — unless for a soul or for corruption in the land — it is as if he had slain mankind entirely; and whoever saves one, it is as if he had saved mankind entirely." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Killing one innocent soul is **like killing all mankind**.

✦ QURAN

﴿... لَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَكُمْ بَيْنَكُمْ بِالْبُطْلِ إِلَّا أَنْ تَكُونَ تِجَارَةً عَنْ تَرَاضٍ مِّنْكُمْ...﴾

"Do not consume one another's wealth unjustly, but only in lawful trade by mutual consent." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ 'Do not kill yourselves.'

(iv) Authority of the state — no private armies

✦ HADITH

مَنْ حَمَلَ عَلَيْنَا السَّلَاحَ فَلَيْسَ مِنَّا

"Whoever takes up arms against us is not of us." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Article **256** of the Constitution forbids private military organisations; **Paigham-e-Pakistan (2018)**: only the state may declare jihad.

(v) Justice

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُونُوا قَوَّامِينَ بِالْقِسْطِ شُهَدَاءَ لِلَّهِ وَلَوْ عَلَىٰ أَنْفُسِكُمْ أَوِ الْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ...﴾

"O you who believe, stand firmly for justice, as witnesses for Allah, even if it be against yourselves, your parents or your relatives." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ **Stand firm for justice**, even against yourselves.

Quick, cheap justice removes the militants' main recruiting promise.

(vi) Economic justice

✦ QURAN

﴿... كَيْ لَا يَكُونَ دُولَةٌ بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ...﴾

"... so that it does not circulate only among the rich among you." (Al-Hashr, Quran)

→ So that wealth does **not circulate only among the rich**.

Zakat, jobs and skills for the young in the most affected districts.

(vii) Truthful information

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا إِن جَاءَكُمْ فَاسِقٌ بِنَبَأٍ فَتَبَيَّنُوا أَن تُصِيبُوا قَوْمًا بِجَهْلَةٍ فَتُصْحَبُوا عَلَىٰ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ نَادِمِينَ﴾

"O you who have believed, if there comes to you a disobedient one with information, investigate, lest you harm a people out of ignorance and become, over what you have done, regretful." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ If a sinful person brings news, **verify it**.

Counter-narratives online; action against hate content (PECA 2016).

(viii) Dialogue with the misled

As **Ali (RA)** sent **Ibn Abbas** to reason with the Khawarij, scholars should engage those at risk; the door of repentance stays open (Al-Ma'idah 34) — as at **Sabaon** in Swat.

(ix) Brotherhood and unity

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ فَأَصْلَحُوا بَيْنَ أَخَوَيْكُمْ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ﴾

"The believers are but brothers, so make settlement between your brothers. And fear Allah that you may receive mercy." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ The believers are but brothers, **so make peace between your brothers**.

✦ HADITH

مَثَلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ فِي تَوَادُّهِمْ وَتَرَاحُمِهِمْ وَتَعَاطُفِهِمْ مَثَلُ الْجَسَدِ

"The believers in their love, mercy and compassion are like one body." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ Inter-sect councils, joint Friday themes and district peace committees make this real.

(x) Good governance and the reach of the state

✦ HADITH

كُلُّكُمْ رَاعٍ وَكُلُّكُمْ مَسْئُولٌ عَنْ رَعِيَّتِهِ

"Each of you is a shepherd and responsible for his flock." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ Schools, courts, police and jobs in every district — the **FATA merger (2018)** extended the Constitution to the tribal areas.

(4) The national measures

- **National Action Plan** (24 December 2014) — 20 points: against militias, hate speech, terror finance; madrasa regulation; criminal-justice reform.
- **Operations** — Rah-e-Rast (2009), Zarb-e-Azb (2014), Radd-ul-Fasaad (2017).
- **Paigham-e-Pakistan** — the ulema's consensus.
- **Madrasa registration** and modern subjects; **FATA merger** (2018).

Reasons and solutions — the names only			
Religious and political	Socio-economic and external	Islamic solutions	National
misreading	poverty	ease	NAP 2014
takfir	youth	no takfir	operations
hate speech	illiteracy	sanctity of life	Paigham-e-Pakistan
misused madrasas	foreign funding	state authority	madrasa reform
Afghan legacy	proxies	justice	FATA merger
weak writ	sanctuaries	Zakat and jobs	
slow justice	grievances	verify news	
	online recruitment	dialogue	
		brotherhood	
		good governance	

Figure 11 · At a glance — reasons and solutions — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(5) Conclusion

♦ HADITH

يَسِّرُوا وَلَا تَعْسِرُوا، وَبَشِّرُوا وَلَا تَنْفِرُوا

"Make things easy, not hard; give good news, do not drive people away." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

The reasons of extremism in Pakistan are religious, political, economic, external and psychological. Its cure lies in the Islam of the Quran and Sunnah — ease, knowledge, sanctity of life, justice and the authority of the state — joined to firm national action.

Why this answer scores

- **Reasons enumerated** in six clear groups, specific to Pakistan.
- **Eight solutions**, each grounded in **Quran or Hadith**, plus the national measures.
- **Balanced**: firm against terror, fair on causes.

Answer 5 · The Motives of Terrorism in Pakistan and How Society Can Get Rid of It (CSS 2018)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2018 · Q4 · 20 marks

Point out the motives of terrorism in Pakistan. How can the society get rid of terrorism?

Define terrorism; its phases; the motives (a table); then the roles of state and society.

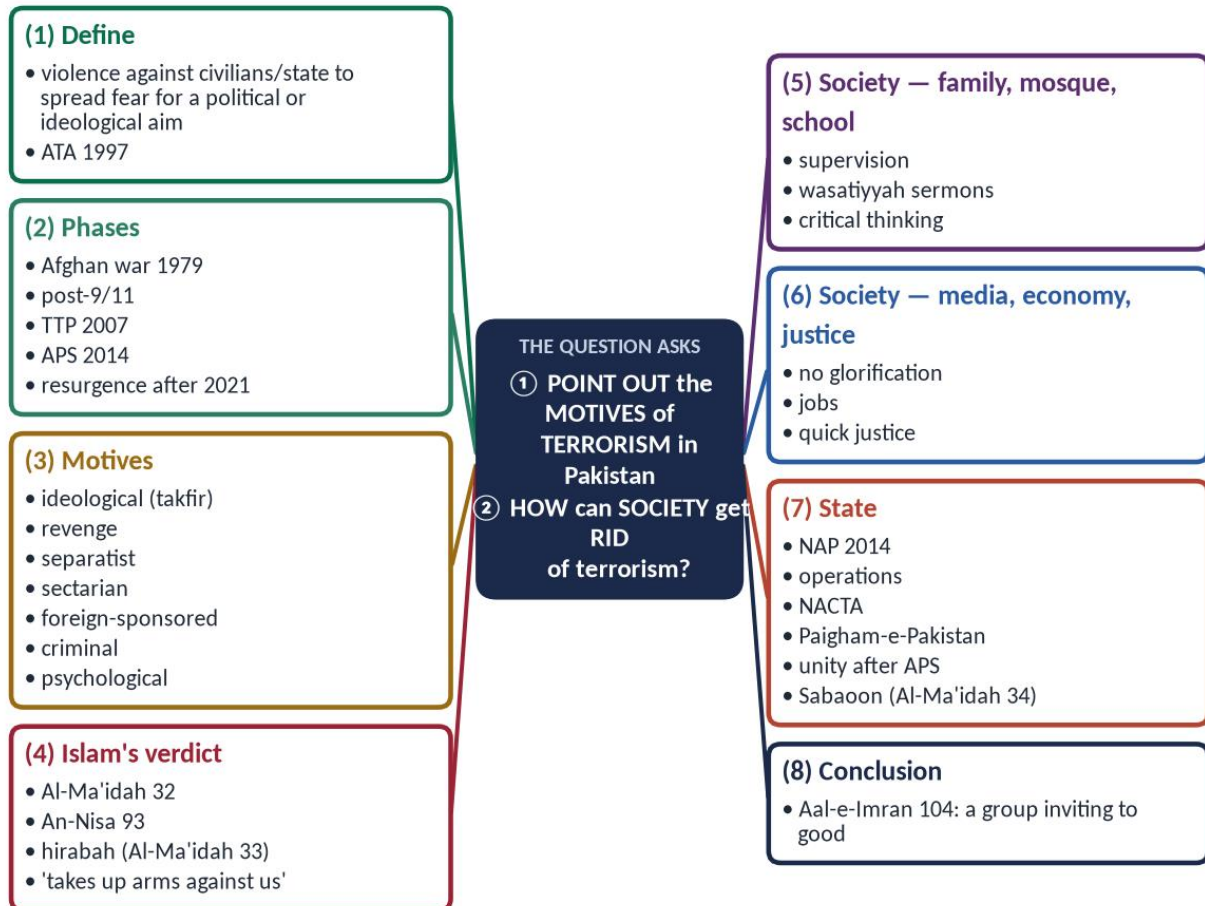


Figure 12 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Motives of terrorism'** — why terrorists act: the intentions and drivers behind their violence (not only general causes of extremism).
- **'How can the society get rid of terrorism'** — the role of **society's institutions** (with the state), practically.

The model answer

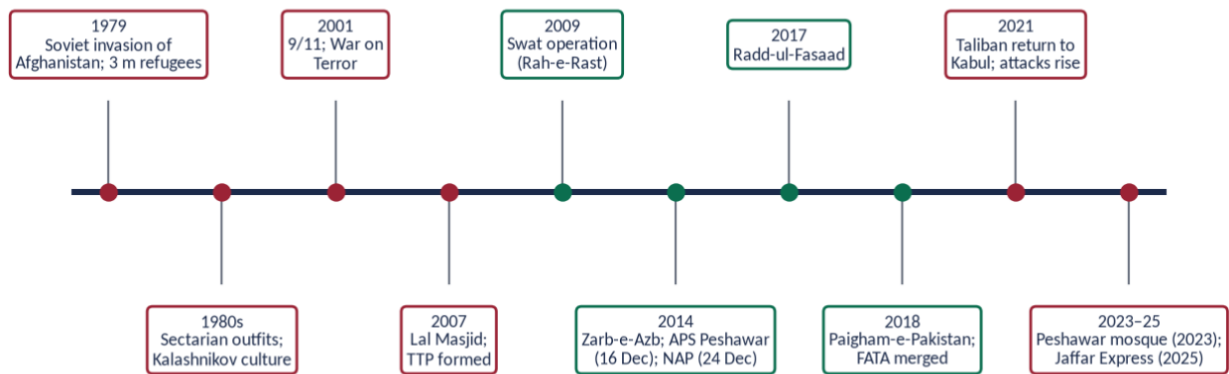
(1) Introduction

Terrorism is violence against civilians or the state to create fear for a political or ideological aim. Pakistan's **Anti-Terrorism Act (1997)** defines it by such acts and aims. Pakistan has been among its

greatest victims — over 80,000 killed between 2001 and 2018, and the **Global Terrorism Index 2025** ranked it second most affected.

Extremism and terrorism differ: extremism is a **mindset** — rigid, exclusive, intolerant; terrorism is **violent action** meant to terrify. Every terrorist is an extremist, but not every extremist becomes a terrorist. The motives below explain the step from mind to bomb.

(2) The phases of terrorism in Pakistan



red = rise of the threat · green = the state's response · over 80,000 Pakistanis killed; losses over \$126 billion (2001–2018)

Figure 13 · Terrorism in Pakistan and the state's response.

- **1979–2001:** the Afghan war — 3 million refugees, weapons, armed groups; sectarian violence.
- **2001–2007:** post-9/11 — militants in the tribal areas; drone strikes.
- **2007–2014:** TTP formed (December 2007); suicide bombings nationwide; Swat.
- **2014–2018:** APS Peshawar (16 December 2014) → NAP; Zarb-e-Azb; Radd-ul-Fasaad — a sharp decline.
- **2021 onwards:** resurgence after the Taliban's return to Kabul; the Peshawar mosque bombing (2023); the Jaffar Express hijacking (2025).

(3) The motives of terrorism

Motive	Explanation
Ideological	To impose their version of Shari'ah by force; takfir of the state and army
Revenge	For military operations, drone strikes and killed relatives
Separatist	Ethnic nationalist groups seeking separation, especially in Balochistan
Sectarian	Killing followers of other schools
Foreign-sponsored	Hostile agencies using militants as proxies (Pakistan cites the Jadhav case, 2016)
Criminal-economic	Extortion, kidnapping for ransom, smuggling and drug money
Psychological	Power, belonging, fame, the lure of 'martyrdom'

Motives, not only causes: poverty and injustice explain why an area is vulnerable; **motives** explain why a particular person or group chooses to kill. Most groups mix several — an ideological cover, a revenge story and a money supply.

The cost: over **80,000** Pakistanis killed and over **126 billion dollars** lost (2001–2018); schools, shrines, mosques, churches and markets attacked; international cricket absent for a decade after 2009.

(4) Islam's verdict on terrorism

✦ QURAN

﴿... مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا وَمَنْ أَحْيَاهَا فَكَأَنَّمَا أَحْيَا النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا...﴾

"Whoever kills a soul — unless for a soul or for corruption in the land — it is as if he had slain mankind entirely; and whoever saves one, it is as if he had saved mankind entirely." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Killing one innocent soul is **like killing all mankind**.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَمَنْ يَقْتُلْ مُؤْمِنًا مُتَعَمِّدًا فَجَزَاؤُهُ جَهَنَّمُ خَالِدًا فِيهَا وَغَضِبَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَلَعَنَهُ وَأَعَدَّ لَهُ عَذَابًا عَظِيمًا﴾

"But whoever kills a believer intentionally - his recompense is Hell, wherein he will abide eternally, and Allah has become angry with him and has cursed him and has prepared for him a great punishment." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Whoever kills a believer intentionally — **his recompense is Hell**.

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّمَا جَزَاءُ الَّذِينَ يُحَارِبُونَ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ وَيَسْعَوْنَ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَسَادًا...﴾

"The recompense of those who wage war against Allah and His Messenger and strive to spread corruption (fasad) in the land ..." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Those who **wage war against Allah and His Messenger and spread fasad** — the crime of **hirabah**.

✦ HADITH

مَنْ حَمَلَ عَلَيْنَا السَّلَاحَ فَلَيْسَ مِنَّا

"Whoever takes up arms against us is not of us." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

The Hanafi position on rebels (baghy): those who take up arms against a lawful Muslim state are first called to dialogue and their grievances heard; if they persist, the state alone may fight them, only to end their rebellion — never to plunder or take revenge (Al-Hujurat 9).

(5) How society can get rid of terrorism

(i) The family

Time, love and supervision; teaching the Prophet's ﷺ mercy; awareness of children's online contacts — often the first to notice radicalisation.

(ii) The mosque and the ulema

Friday sermons on **wasatiyyah**, the sanctity of life and the prohibition of suicide; a code against hate speech; **Paigham-e-Pakistan** taught from the pulpit.

★ HADITH

مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسَهُ بِحَدِيدَةٍ فَحَدِيدَتُهُ فِي يَدِهِ يَتَوَجَّأُ بِهَا فِي بَطْنِهِ فِي نَارِ جَهَنَّمَ خَالِدًا مُخَلَّدًا فِيهَا أَبَدًا

“Whoever kills himself with a weapon will stab himself with it in the Fire of Hell for ever.” (Muslim)

→ The answer to the 'martyrdom' lie.

(iii) Schools, colleges and madrasas

Critical thinking; the Seerah of mercy; civic education; modern subjects in madrasas; debating and sports.

(iv) Media and social media

No glorification of terrorists (NAP point 11); counter-narratives; digital literacy — 'verify the news' (Al-Hujurat 6).

(v) The economy and civil society

Jobs, skills and loans for youth (Akhawat's interest-free model); welfare through Zakat; youth clubs and volunteering.

(vi) Cooperation with the state

Reporting suspicious activity; refusing to shelter or fund militants; supporting the police.

(vii) National unity against terror

★ HADITH

مَثَلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ فِي تَوَادِّهِمْ وَتَرَاحِمِهِمْ وَتَعَاطُفِهِمْ مَثَلُ الْجَسَدِ

“The believers in their love, mercy and compassion are like one body.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

After **APS Peshawar (2014)**, all political parties met and agreed on the **National Action Plan** within days — proof that a united society denies terrorists their aim of division. Care for victims' families and honour for the martyred police and soldiers keep that unity alive.

(viii) Rehabilitation — the door of repentance

★ QURAN

﴿إِلَّا الَّذِينَ تَابُوا مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ تَقْدِرُوا عَلَيْهِمْ فَاعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ﴾

“Except for those who return [repenting] before you apprehend them. And know that Allah is Forgiving and Merciful.” (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ 'Except those who repent before you overpower them — know that Allah is Forgiving, Merciful.'

Centres such as **Sabaoon** (Swat) have returned hundreds of young former militants to normal life through education, counselling and skills.

(6) The role of the state

- **National Action Plan** (2014), **NACTA** (2013), provincial counter-terrorism departments.
- **Operations** — Zarb-e-Azb, Radd-ul-Fasaad and later.
- **FATF** compliance (grey list exit, 2022) — terror financing choked.

- **Justice reform, FATA merger (2018), border fencing, de-radicalisation** (Sabaoon).

Terrorism in Pakistan — the names only			
Phases	Motives	Society	State
1979	ideology	family	NAP
post-9/11	revenge	mosque	NACTA
TTP 2007	separatism	schools and madrasas	operations
APS and NAP 2014	sectarian	media	FATF exit 2022
resurgence 2021	foreign	economy	justice reform
	criminal	cooperation with the state	FATA
	psychological		Sabaoon

Figure 14 · At a glance — terrorism in Pakistan — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(7) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلْتَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ أُمَّةٌ يَدْعُونَ إِلَى الْخَيْرِ وَيَأْمُرُونَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَيَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ﴾

“And let there be [arising] from you a nation inviting to [all that is] good, enjoining what is right and forbidding what is wrong, and those will be the successful.” (Aal-e-Imran, Quran)

→ 'Let there be among you a group inviting to good, enjoining right and forbidding wrong.'

Terrorism in Pakistan has many motives — ideological, vengeful, separatist, sectarian, foreign and criminal. The state can defeat terrorists; only **society** can defeat terrorism, by closing every door through which young people are drawn into it.

Why this answer scores

- It **defines terrorism** and separates **motives** from general causes, in a table.
- The **phases** show command of Pakistan's recent history.
- 'How can **society** get rid' gets its own detailed heading, with the state's role alongside.

Answer 6 · The Motives of Extremism and How Society Can Get Rid of It by Following Islam (CSS 2023)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q7 · 20 marks

What are the motives of extremism in Pakistan? How can the society get rid of extremism by following the teachings of Islam?

Motives through the push-pull lens; then the Islamic teachings each part of society must follow.

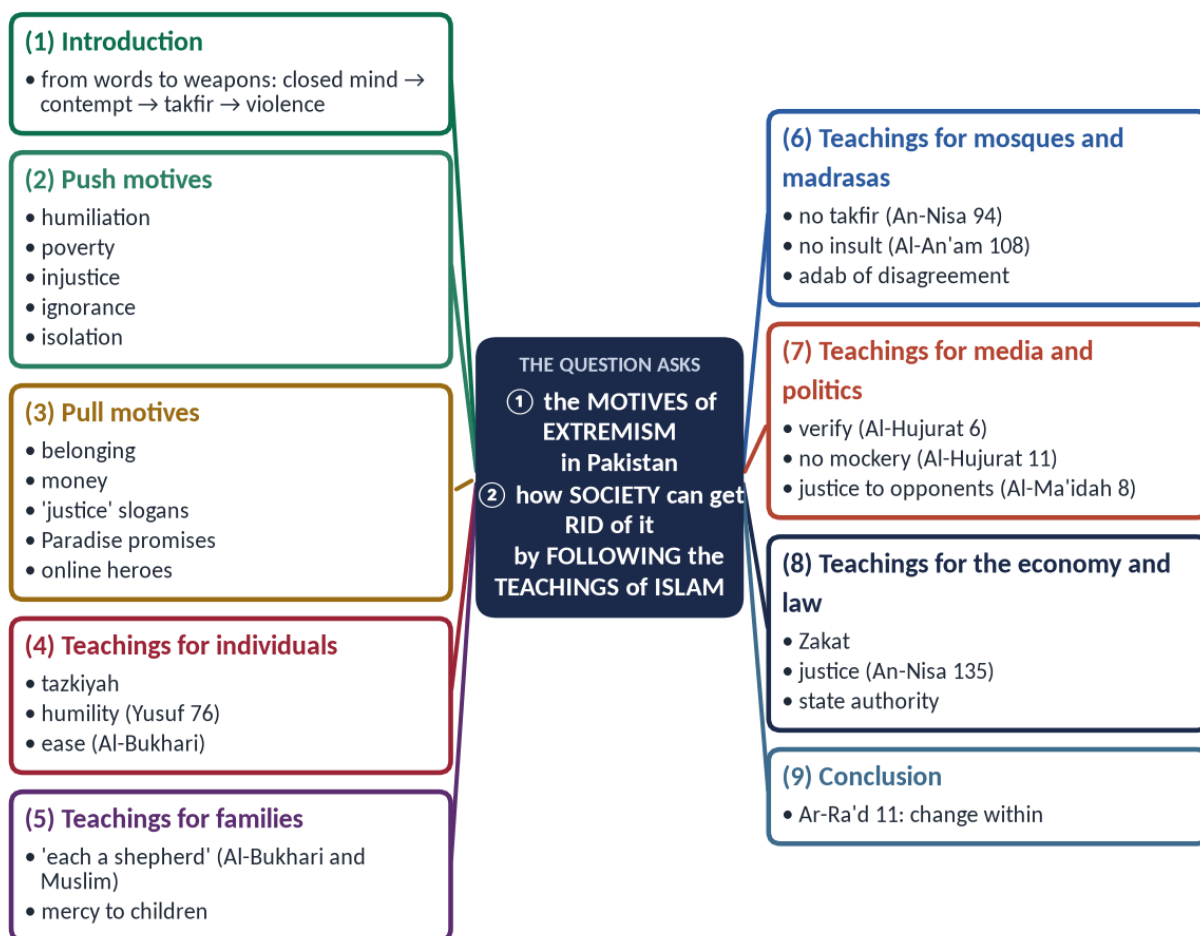


Figure 15 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Motives of extremism'** — why people become extremists: the drivers in their minds and circumstances.
- **'How can the society get rid of extremism by following the teachings of Islam'** — each part of society, and the **specific Islamic teaching** it must follow.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Extremism in Pakistan did not appear overnight; it grows in steps — a **closed mind** ('only we are right'), **contempt** for others, **takfir**, **dehumanisation**, and finally **violence**. To stop it, we must understand **why** people take the first step, and how Islam's own teachings can stop them.

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَفَوْقَ كُلِّ ذِي عِلْمٍ عَلِيمٌ﴾

"And over every possessor of knowledge is one more knowing." (Yusuf, Quran)

→ The **humility** that prevents the first step.

(2) The motives of extremism — push and pull

(i) Push factors — what drives people out of normal society

- **Humiliation and grievance** — injustice, loss of relatives in violence, perceived insults to religion.
- **Poverty and unemployment** — about two-thirds of Pakistanis are under 30, many without jobs.
- **Injustice** — slow courts, corruption, the powerful above the law.
- **Ignorance** — half-knowledge of religion without teachers and context.
- **Isolation** — lonely young people spending long hours online.

(ii) Pull factors — what draws them to extremist groups

- **Belonging** — a 'brotherhood' and a sense of purpose.
- **Money, status and weapons.**
- **Simple slogans** — 'Islamic justice', 'the enemies of Islam'.
- **Promises of Paradise and 'martyrdom'.**
- **Online heroes** — slick videos and secret communities.

(iii) Sectarian and political motives

Hatred of other schools, fed by hate literature; political polarisation that treats opponents as traitors.

(3) How society can get rid of extremism by following the teachings of Islam

(i) The individual — purification and humility

✦ QURAN

﴿قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا ۖ وَقَدْ خَابَ مَنْ دَسَّاهَا﴾

"He has succeeded who purifies it. And he has failed who instills it [with corruption]." (Ash-Shams, Quran)

→ He has succeeded who purifies it, and failed who corrupts it.

✦ HADITH

إِنَّ الدِّينَ يَسْرٌ، وَلَنْ يُشَادَّ الدِّينَ أَحَدٌ إِلَّا غَلَبَهُ

"The religion is easy; no one makes it hard except that it overcomes him." (Al-Bukhari)

(ii) The family — responsibility and mercy

★ HADITH

كُلُّكُمْ رَاعٍ وَكُلُّكُمْ مَسْئُولٌ عَنْ رَعِيَّتِهِ

“Each of you is a shepherd, and each is responsible for his flock.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Time with children, knowledge of their friends and online life; mercy, not harshness.

(iii) The mosque and the madrasa — no takfir, no insult

★ QURAN

﴿... إِذَا ضَرَبْتُمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَتَبَيَّنُوا وَلَا تَقُولُوا لِمَنْ أَلْفَى إِلَيْكُمْ أَلَسْتُمْ مُؤْمِنًا...﴾

“O you who believe, when you go forth in the cause of Allah, verify, and do not say to one who offers you peace, ‘You are not a believer.’” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Do not say to one who offers you peace, ‘**You are not a believer.**’

★ QURAN

﴿وَلَا تَسُبُّوا الَّذِينَ يَدْعُونَ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ فَيَسُبُّوا اللَّهَ عَدْوًا بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ...﴾

“Do not insult those they invoke besides Allah, lest they insult Allah in enmity, without knowledge.” (Al-An'am, Quran)

→ **Do not insult** what others hold sacred.

Teach the **adab of disagreement** — the Imams respected one another; Imam Malik refused to impose his *Muwatta* on all.

(iv) Schools and universities — knowledge and critical thinking

The Seerah of mercy; the Charter of Madinah; asking for evidence before believing.

(v) Media and politics — truth and justice

★ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنْ جَاءَكُمْ فَاسِقٌ بِنَبَأٍ فَتَبَيَّنُوا أَنْ تُصِيبُوا قَوْمًا بِجَهْلَةٍ فَتُصْحَبُوا عَلَىٰ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ

نَدِمِينَ﴾

“O you who have believed, if there comes to you a disobedient one with information, investigate, lest you harm a people out of ignorance and become, over what you have done, regretful.” (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ If a sinful person brings news, **verify it**.

★ QURAN

﴿... لَا يَسَخَرُ قَوْمٌ مِّنْ قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِّنْ نِّسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُنَّ خَيْرًا مِّنْهُنَّ...﴾

“Let not a people ridicule another people — perhaps they are better than them; nor let women ridicule other women — perhaps they are better than them.” (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ **Do not mock** one another or call one another offensive names.

✦ QURAN

﴿... وَلَا يَجْرِمَنَّكُمْ شَنَاٰنُ قَوْمٍ عَلَىٰٓ أَلَّا تَعْدِلُوْا أَعْدِلُوْا هُوَ أَقْرَبُ لِلتَّقْوَىٰ...﴾

“Do not let the hatred of a people lead you to be unjust. Be just; that is nearer to righteousness.” (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Do not let hatred lead you to injustice.

(vi) The economy — justice and opportunity

✦ QURAN

﴿... كَيْ لَا يَكُوْنَ دُوْلَةٌ بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ...﴾

“... so that it does not circulate only among the rich among you.” (Al-Hashr, Quran)

→ So that wealth does **not circulate only among the rich**.

Zakat, jobs, skills and youth programmes remove the push of poverty.

(vii) The law — justice and the state's authority

✦ QURAN

﴿يَٰٓأَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا كُونُوا قَوِّمِينَ بِالْقِسْطِ شُهَدَآءَ لِلّٰهِ وَلَوْ عَلَىٰٓ أَنْفُسِكُمْ أَوِ الْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ...﴾

“O you who believe, stand firmly for justice, as witnesses for Allah, even if it be against yourselves, your parents or your relatives.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Stand firm for justice.

✦ HADITH

مَنْ خَرَجَ مِنَ الطَّاعَةِ، وَفَارَقَ الْجَمَاعَةَ فَمَاتَ، مَاتَ مِيتَةً جَاهِلِيَّةً

“Whoever leaves obedience and separates from the community dies a death of Jahiliyyah.” (Muslim)

→ No private armies — Paigham-e-Pakistan (2018).

(viii) Courage to protect the victim

✦ HADITH

اَنْصُرْ اَخَاكَ ظَالِمًا اَوْ مَظْلُوْمًا

“Help your brother, whether he is an oppressor or oppressed.” (Al-Bukhari)

→ Helping the oppressor means **stopping him**.

When a mob killed a Sri Lankan factory manager in **Sialkot (December 2021)**, a colleague, **Malik Adnan**, tried to shield him and was later honoured with the **Tamgha-e-Shujaat** — the conduct a society free of extremism rewards.

(4) What society and state must do together

Part of society	What it must do
-----------------	-----------------

Part of society	What it must do
Family	Supervise, love, teach mercy
Mosque and ulema	Wasatiyyah sermons; Paigham-e-Pakistan; no hate speech
Schools and madrasas	Critical thinking; modern subjects; the Seerah of mercy
Media	Counter-narratives; no glorification; digital literacy
Economy and civil society	Jobs, skills, interest-free loans, youth clubs
State	NAP; quick justice; madrasa registration; de-radicalisation (Sabaoon)

Motives and society's cure — the names only		
Motives	Islamic teachings	Society
push — humiliation, poverty, injustice, ignorance, isolation	purification	family
pull — belonging, money, slogans, 'martyrdom', online heroes	ease	mosque
	'each a shepherd'	school
	no takfir	media
	no insult	economy
	adab of disagreement	state
	verify	
	justice	
	Zakat	
	state authority	

Figure 16 · At a glance — motives and society's cure — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(5) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿... إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُغَيِّرُ مَا بِقَوْمٍ حَتَّى يُغَيِّرُوا مَا بِأَنْفُسِهِمْ...﴾

"Indeed, Allah will not change the condition of a people until they change what is in themselves." (Ar-Ra'd, Quran)

→ Allah does not change the condition of a people **until they change what is in themselves**.

The motives of extremism — grievance, poverty, ignorance and the lure of belonging — can be answered only by a society that **lives** the teachings of Islam: purification, mercy in the family, knowledge and humility in the mosque, truth in the media, justice in the economy and law.

Why this answer scores

- The **push-pull** analysis gives the motives depth beyond a simple list.
- Society's cure is organised **institution by institution**, each with its **Islamic teaching** — exactly 'by following the teachings of Islam'.
- A different shape from Answers 4 and 5 for a near-identical question.

Answer 7 · Eliminating Religious and Political Extremism through the Teachings of the Holy Prophet ﷺ (CSS 2024)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2024 · Q7 · 20 marks

How is it possible to eliminate the religious and political extremism in Pakistan in the light of the teachings of the Holy Prophet (ﷺ)? Explain.

Two main headings — religious and political — each built from the Prophet's (PBUH) teachings, then the practical plan.

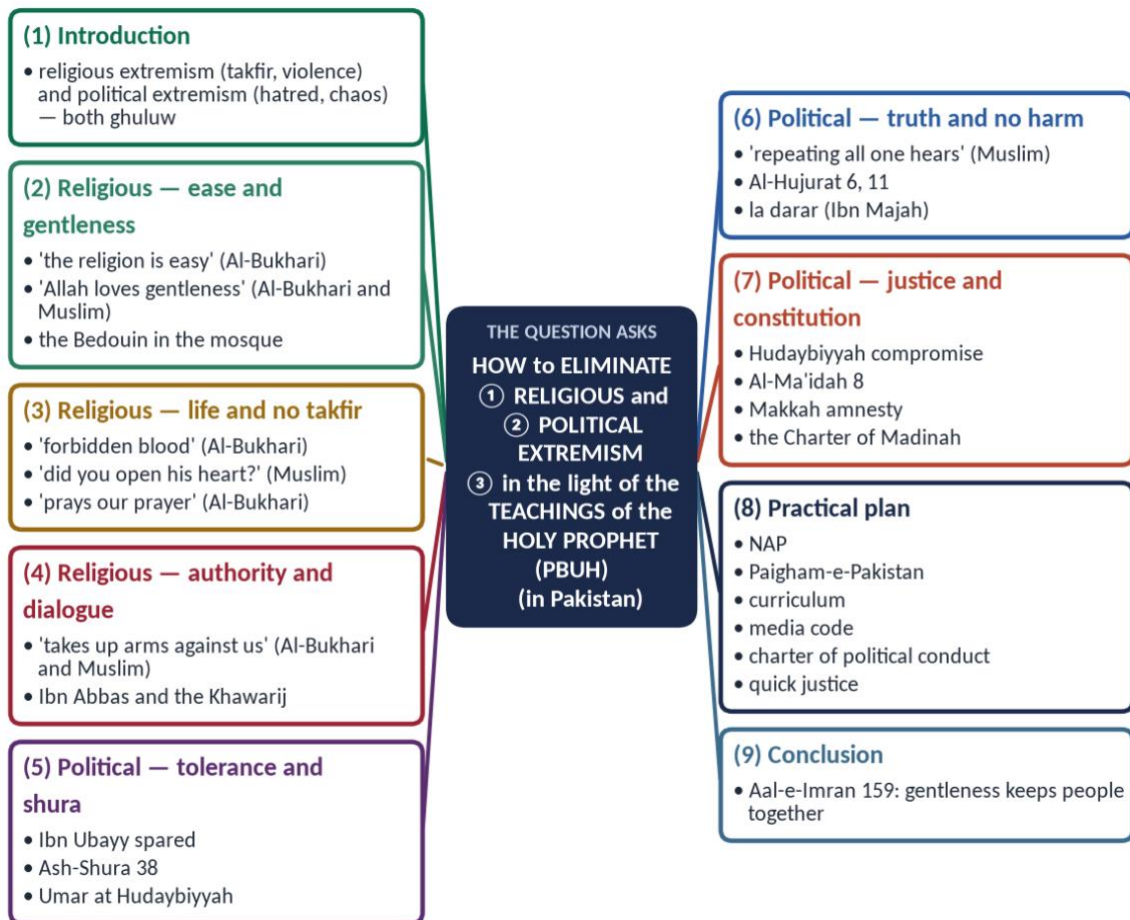


Figure 17 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- Two kinds of extremism — religious and political — each needs its own heading.
- 'In the light of the teachings of the Holy Prophet ﷺ' — the evidence must be mainly **hadith and Seerah**.
- 'How is it possible ... in Pakistan' — end with a practical plan.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Pakistan faces two extremisms: **religious** — takfir, sectarian hatred and violence in God's name; and **political** — hatred of opponents, abuse, fake news, street violence and contempt for institutions. Both are **ghuluw** (غلو) — going beyond limits — and both were answered by the Holy Prophet ﷺ in word and example.

★ HADITH

إِيَّاكُمْ وَالْغُلُوَّ فِي الدِّينِ، فَإِنَّمَا أَهْلَكَ مَنْ كَانَ قَبْلَكُمْ الْغُلُوَّ فِي الدِّينِ

"Beware of extremism in religion, for it destroyed those before you." (Al-Nasa'i and Ibn Majah)

(2) Eliminating religious extremism — the teachings of the Prophet ﷺ

(i) Ease, not hardship

★ HADITH

إِنَّ الدِّينَ يَسْرٌ، وَلَنْ يَشَادَّ الدِّينَ أَحَدٌ إِلَّا غَلَبَهُ

"The religion is easy; no one makes it hard except that it overcomes him." (Al-Bukhari)

He corrected the three men who vowed extreme worship — 'whoever turns from my Sunnah is not of me' — and asked Mu'adh, 'Are you a trouble-maker?' for lengthening the prayer (Al-Bukhari).

(ii) Gentleness in correction

★ HADITH

إِنَّ اللَّهَ رَفِيقٌ يُحِبُّ الرِّفْقَ فِي الْأَمْرِ كُلِّهِ

"Allah is gentle and loves gentleness in every matter." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

The Bedouin who urinated in the mosque was taught, not beaten.

(iii) The sanctity of life

★ HADITH

لَنْ يَزَالَ الْمُؤْمِنُ فِي فُسْحَةٍ مِنْ دِينِهِ مَا لَمْ يُصِبْ دَمًا حَرَامًا

"The believer remains within the scope of his religion as long as he does not shed forbidden blood." (Al-Bukhari)

Suicide is forbidden (An-Nisa 29); a suicide attacker 'stabs himself in the Fire' (Muslim).

(iv) No takfir

When **Usamah (RA)** killed a man who had said 'La ilaha illallah', the Prophet ﷺ asked, 'Did you open his heart?' (Muslim).

✦ HADITH

مَنْ صَلَّى صَلَاتَنَا، وَاسْتَقْبَلَ قِبْلَتَنَا، وَأَكَلَ ذَيْحَتَنَا، فَذَلِكَ الْمُسْلِمُ

"Whoever prays our prayer, faces our qiblah and eats our slaughtered meat is a Muslim." (Al-Bukhari)

(v) No private armies — the authority of the state

✦ HADITH

مَنْ حَمَلَ عَلَيْنَا السَّلَاحَ فَلَيْسَ مِنَّا

"Whoever takes up arms against us is not of us." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

'Changing a wrong **with the hand**' belongs to lawful authority, not private groups.

(vi) Dialogue and the open door

The Prophet ﷺ did not punish **Dhul-Khuwaysirah**; **Ali (RA)** sent **Ibn Abbas** to reason with the Khawarij, and thousands returned. Those who lay down arms are accepted (Al-Ma'idah 34).

(3) Eliminating political extremism — the teachings of the Prophet ﷺ

(i) Tolerance of opposition

The Prophet ﷺ tolerated **Abdullah ibn Ubayy**, leader of the hypocrites, and refused to kill him: 'People will say Muhammad kills his companions' (Al-Bukhari).

(ii) Consultation and respect for dissent

✦ QURAN

﴿وَالَّذِينَ اسْتَجَابُوا لِرَبِّهِمْ وَأَقَامُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَأَمْرُهُمْ شُورَى بَيْنَهُمْ وَمِمَّا رَزَقْنَاهُمْ يُنْفِقُونَ﴾

"And those who have responded to their lord and established prayer and whose affair is [determined by] consultation among themselves, and from what We have provided them, they spend." (Ash-Shura, Quran)

→ Their affairs are **by consultation among themselves**.

He followed the majority at Uhud; he answered Umar's (RA) strong objections at **Hudaybiyyah** with patience.

(iii) Truthful speech — no propaganda

✦ HADITH

كَفَى بِالْمَرْءِ كَذِبًا أَنْ يُحَدِّثَ بِكُلِّ مَا سَمِعَ

"It is enough of a lie for a man to repeat everything he hears." (Muslim)

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا إِن جَاءَكُمْ فَاسِقٌ بِنَبَأٍ فَتَبَيَّنُوا أَن تُصِيبُوا قَوْمًا بِجَهْلَةٍ فَتُصْحَبُوا عَلَىٰ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ نَادِمِينَ﴾

"O you who have believed, if there comes to you a disobedient one with information, investigate, lest you harm a people out of ignorance and become, over what you have done, regretful." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ If a sinful person brings news, **verify it**.

✦ QURAN

﴿... لَا يَسْخَرُ قَوْمٌ مِّن قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِّن نِّسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُنَّ خَيْرًا مِّنْهُنَّ ...﴾

"Let not a people ridicule another people — perhaps they are better than them; nor let women ridicule other women — perhaps they are better than them." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ **Do not mock** one another or call one another offensive names.

(iv) Compromise for the common good

At **Hudaybiyyah (628)** the Prophet ﷺ accepted that 'Messenger of Allah' be struck from the treaty and agreed to terms that seemed unequal — for the sake of peace. The Quran called the result '**a clear victory**' (Al-Fath 1). Politics by compromise, not by 'all or nothing', is the Sunnah.

(v) No harm to public life

✦ HADITH

لَا ضَرَرَ وَلَا ضِرَارَ

"There is to be no harm and no returning of harm." (Ibn Majah)

→ No burning of property, no blocking of roads, no attacks on institutions.

(vi) Justice to opponents

✦ QURAN

﴿... وَلَا يَجْرِمَنَّكُمْ شَنَاٰنُ قَوْمٍ عَلَىٰ ٓأَلَّا تَعْدِلُوا ۖ اَعْدِلُوا هُوَ اَقْرَبُ لِلتَّقْوَىٰ ...﴾

"Do not let the hatred of a people lead you to be unjust. Be just; that is nearer to righteousness." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Do not let the hatred of a people lead you to injustice — **be just**.

(vii) Forgiveness instead of revenge

At **Ta'if** he prayed for those who stoned him instead of cursing them; at the **Conquest of Makkah (630)** he told his bitterest opponents, '**No blame on you today; go, you are free.**' Political victory without revenge ended decades of hostility — the opposite of today's culture of vendetta.

(viii) A constitution for all

The **Charter of Madinah** bound different communities to one agreed law and one arbiter — the model of settling political differences through the **Constitution and courts**.

(4) The practical plan for Pakistan

Area	Measures
Religious	NAP (2014) against hate speech and militias; Paigham-e-Pakistan in curricula; madrasa registration and modern subjects; de-radicalisation (Sabaoon)
Political	A charter of political conduct; respect for election results and courts; party training in tolerance
Media	A code against hate and fake news; fact-checking; PECA 2016 applied fairly
Education	The Seerah of mercy; the Charter of Madinah; critical thinking; debating culture
Justice	Quick trials; one law for all; punishment of mob violence (Sialkot 2021, Jaranwala 2023)
Youth	Jobs, skills, sports and civic participation

Religious and political extremism — the names only		
Religious	Political	Plan
ease	tolerance (Ibn Ubayy)	NAP
gentleness	shura	Paigham-e-Pakistan
sanctity of life	truthful speech	madrasas
no suicide	Hudaybiyyah compromise	political charter
no takfir ('open his heart')	la darar	media code
no private arms	justice to opponents	education
dialogue and repentance	Makkah amnesty	justice
	the Charter	youth

Figure 18 · At a glance — religious and political extremism — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(5) Conclusion

★ QURAN

﴿فَبِمَا رَحْمَةٍ مِّنَ اللَّهِ لِنْتَ لَهُمْ وَلَوْ كُنْتَ فَظًّا غَلِيظَ الْقَلْبِ لَانْفَضُّوا مِنْ حَوْلِكَ...﴾

“So by mercy from Allah you were gentle with them; had you been harsh and hard-hearted, they would have scattered from around you.” (Aal-e-Imran, Quran)

→ By Allah's mercy **you were gentle with them**; had you been harsh and hard-hearted, they would have scattered from around you.

The Prophet ﷺ answered religious extremism with ease, mercy, the sanctity of life and the refusal of takfir; he answered political extremism with tolerance, consultation, truth and justice. If Pakistan's pulpits, parties, media and courts follow these teachings, both extremisms can be eliminated.

Why this answer scores

- **Religious and political** extremism each get a full heading — both limbs of the question.
- The evidence is mainly **hadith and Seerah**, as 'teachings of the Holy Prophet ﷺ' demands.
- A **practical plan table** answers 'how is it possible ... in Pakistan'.

Answer 8 · Sectarianism and Polarisation in the Muslim World: Causes and Solutions (CSS 2026)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q7 · 20 marks

Examine the causes of sectarianism and polarization in the Muslim World. Suggest solutions in the light of Islamic teachings.

Difference vs division; causes at six levels; solutions from the Quran, the Sunnah and the Imams.

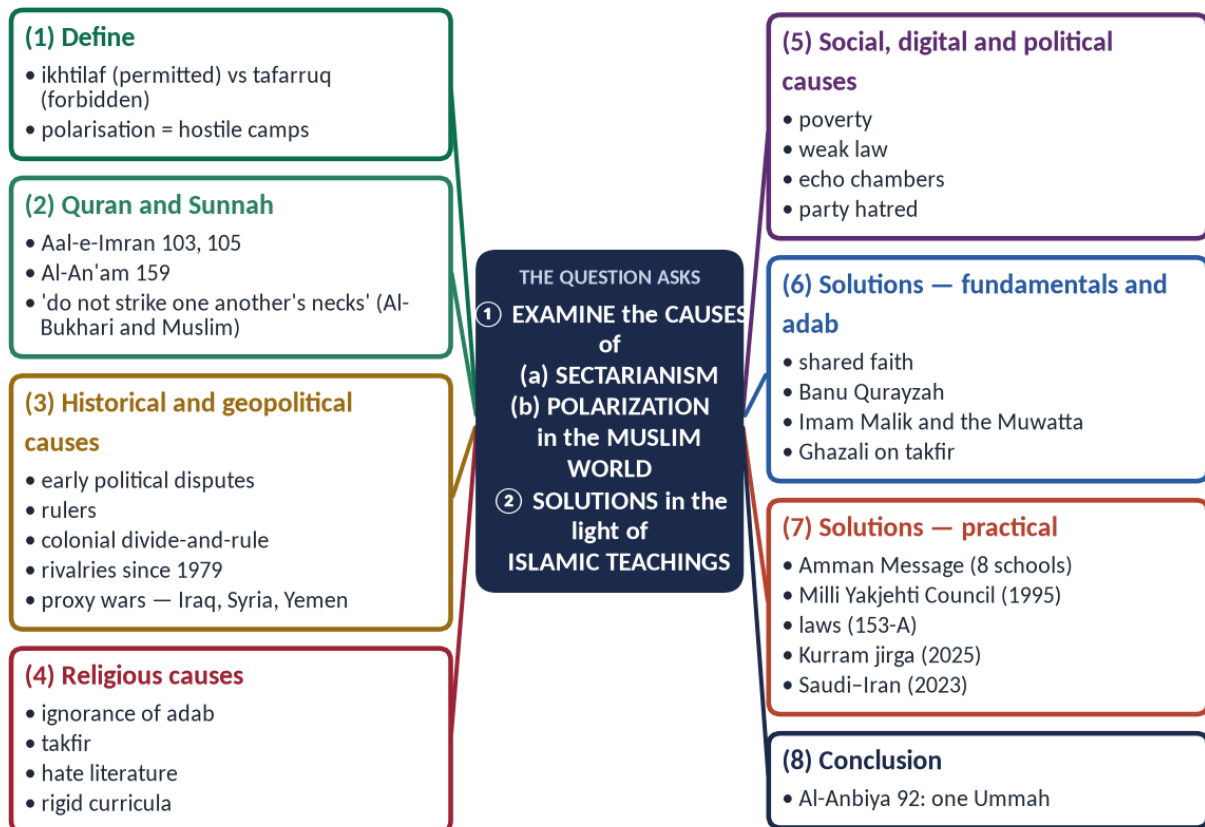


Figure 19 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Examine the causes'** — analyse, not merely list: historical, geopolitical, religious, social, digital and political causes.
- **Two words** — **sectarianism** (religious division) and **polarization** (hostile camps of every kind).
- **'Solutions in the light of Islamic teachings'** — Quran, Sunnah, the conduct of the Imams, and practical steps.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Islam permits **difference** (ikhtilaf, اِخْتِلَافٌ) — the Imams differed on hundreds of questions — but forbids **division** (tafarruq, تَفَرُّقٌ) that turns difference into hatred and war. **Sectarianism** is that division in religion; **polarization** is its wider form — society split into hostile religious, political and ideological camps.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَأَعْتَصِمُوا بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا وَلَا تَفَرَّقُوا وَاذْكُرُوا نِعْمَتَ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ إِذْ كُنْتُمْ أَعْدَاءً فَأَلَّفَ بَيْنَ قُلُوبِكُمْ فَأَصْبَحْتُمْ بِنِعْمَتِهِ إِخْوَانًا...﴾

"And hold firmly to the rope of Allah all together and do not become divided. Remember Allah's favour upon you: you were enemies, and He brought your hearts together, and by His favour you became brothers." (Aal-e-Imran, Quran)

→ 'Hold fast to the rope of Allah all together and do not be divided.'

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّ الَّذِينَ فَرَّقُوا دِينَهُمْ وَكَانُوا شِيعًا لَسْتَ فِي شَيْءٍ إِنَّمَا أَمْرُهُمْ إِلَى اللَّهِ ثُمَّ يُنَبِّئُهُم بِمَا كَانُوا يَفْعَلُونَ﴾

"Indeed, those who have divided their religion and become sects - you, [O Muhammad], are not [associated] with them in anything. Their affair is only [left] to Allah; then He will inform them about what they used to do." (Al-An'am, Quran)

→ Those who divided their religion and became sects — **you have nothing to do with them.**

✦ HADITH

لَا تَرْجِعُوا بَعْدِي كُفَّارًا يَضْرِبُ بَعْضُكُمْ رِقَابَ بَعْضٍ

"Do not become disbelievers after me, striking one another's necks." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ The Farewell Pilgrimage warning.

(2) The causes of sectarianism and polarization

(i) Historical

Early political disputes over leadership hardened over centuries into theological identities; rulers used divisions to control people; **colonial 'divide and rule'** counted and separated communities by sect.

(ii) Geopolitical

Since **1979**, regional powers have backed rival groups; **proxy wars** in **Iraq** (from 2003), **Syria** (from 2011) and **Yemen** (from 2014–15) killed hundreds of thousands and displaced millions. Pakistan, too, felt this through foreign funding of sectarian groups in the 1980s–90s.

(iii) Religious

- **Ignorance of the adab of disagreement.**
- **Takfir** of other schools.

- **Hate literature**, inflammatory sermons, misuse of loudspeakers.
- **Rigid curricula** that teach only the refutation of others.

(iv) Social and economic

Poverty and frustration channelled into group hatred; weak rule of law — target killings go unpunished (Pakistan's hotspots: Karachi, Quetta, Jhang, Gilgit-Baltistan, **Kurram**).

(v) Digital

Social media echo chambers — algorithms reward outrage; fake videos and quotes spread in minutes.

(vi) Political

Party politics built on hatred; the language of 'traitor' and 'infidel' in political speech; distrust of institutions — the core of **polarization**.

(vii) The consequences

Hundreds of thousands killed in sectarian wars in Iraq, Syria and Yemen; target killings of doctors, lawyers and scholars in Pakistan; a paralysed OIC; and weakened support for Palestine and Kashmir. Division turns the Ummah's strength against itself.

(3) The solutions in the light of Islamic teachings

(i) Unity on the fundamentals

One Allah, one Prophet ﷺ, one Quran, one qiblah, the same pillars and articles of faith — what unites is far greater than what divides.

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّ هَذِهِ أُمَّتُكُمْ أُمَّةً وَاحِدَةً وَأَنَا رَبُّكُمْ فَاعْبُدُونِ﴾

"Indeed this, your religion, is one religion, and I am your Lord, so worship Me." (Al-Anbiya, Quran)

→ 'This Ummah of yours is one Ummah.'

(ii) The adab of disagreement — the example of the Imams

- At **Banu Qurayzah**, the Prophet ﷺ approved two different readings of one command (Al-Bukhari).
- **Imam Malik** refused Caliph Harun al-Rashid's offer to impose his *Muwatta* on the empire.
- The four Imams respected one another despite their differences.

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Imam al-Ghazali · Faysal al-Tafriqah; Al-Iqtisad

To spare a thousand disbelievers by mistake is lighter than to shed the blood of one Muslim by mistake.

→ The classical **caution against takfir**.

(iii) No takfir

✦ QURAN

﴿... إِذَا ضَرَبْتُمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَتَبَيَّنُوا وَلَا تَقُولُوا لِمَنْ أَلْفَىٰ إِلَيْكُمْ أَسْلَمَ لَسْتَ مُؤْمِنًا...﴾

"O you who believe, when you go forth in the cause of Allah, verify, and do not say to one who offers you peace, 'You are not a believer.'" (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Do not say to one who offers you peace, **'You are not a believer.'**

The **Amman Message** (2004–2005), endorsed by some 200 scholars, recognised **eight schools of law** and forbade declaring their followers disbelievers.

(iv) Reconciliation

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ فَأَصْلَحُوا بَيْنَ أَخَوَيْكُمْ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ﴾

"The believers are but brothers, so make settlement between your brothers. And fear Allah that you may receive mercy." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ The believers are but brothers, **so make peace between your brothers.**

The **Kurram peace agreement (January 2025)**, reached through a grand jirga after the November 2024 violence, shows the method.

(v) Education

Curricula on the adab of disagreement, comparative fiqh taught with respect, the history of the Imams' friendship, and critical thinking.

(vi) Law and governance

Enforcement against hate speech and sectarian violence — **PPC 153-A, 295-A**, the **Anti-Terrorism Act 1997**; loudspeaker laws (Punjab, 2015); a ban on armed groups (NAP).

(vii) Joint platforms

The **Milli Yakjehti Council** (1995); **Paigham-e-Pakistan** (2018), signed by scholars of all schools; codes of conduct for Muharram and religious gatherings.

(viii) Against political polarization

Verify news (Al-Hujurat 6); no mockery (Al-Hujurat 11); justice to opponents (Al-Ma'idah 8); consultation (Ash-Shura 38); a charter of political conduct.

(ix) At the level of the Muslim world

End proxy wars; dialogue through the OIC; the **Saudi–Iran rapprochement** brokered in **Beijing (March 2023)** as a model.

Sectarianism and polarization — the names only		
Causes	Islamic solutions	Practical
history	unity on fundamentals	education
colonial divide-and-rule	adab (Banu Qurayzah, Malik, Ghazali)	laws (153-A, ATA)
geopolitics and proxies (Iraq, Syria, Yemen)	no takfir (Amman)	Milli Yakjehti Council
ignorance, takfir, hate speech	reconciliation (Al-Hujurat 9-10 Kurram 2025)	Paigham-e-Pakistan
poverty, weak law		political charter
echo chambers		OIC
party hatred		Saudi-Iran 2023

Figure 20 · At a glance — sectarianism and polarization — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

A simple rule for every Muslim: differ with evidence and respect, never with abuse or takfir; judge a person by his own words, not by his group's label; and leave final judgement to Allah.

(4) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿وَأَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ وَلَا تَزْعُمُوا فَتَفْشَلُوا وَتَذْهَبَ رِيحُكُمْ وَاصْبِرُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ﴾

“And obey Allah and His Messenger, and do not dispute and [thus] lose courage and [then] your strength would depart; and be patient. Indeed, Allah is with the patient.” (Al-Anfal, Quran)

→ 'Do not dispute, lest you lose courage and your strength departs.'

Sectarianism and polarization grow from history, geopolitics, ignorance, injustice and digital outrage. Islam's answer is to keep the difference and drop the division: unity on the fundamentals, the adab of the Imams, no takfir, reconciliation, just laws and a responsible media. That is the path from a divided Ummah back to 'one body'.

Why this answer scores

- It **examines** causes at six levels, covering both **sectarianism** and **polarization**.
- Solutions come from the **Quran, Sunnah and the Imams**, then practical steps.
- Current cases (Kurram 2025, Saudi-Iran 2023) show **up-to-date** knowledge.